

allows you to establish habits and routines around those things. The hamster wheel of the standard path takes energy to keep pace. It is hard to escape. Choosing FI removes the resistance that makes it so difficult to be the best version of yourself and allows you to use that force to create a wind behind your back, pushing you toward a healthier life.

Cable TV and Cell Phones

You can save substantial money every month if you veer away from “normal” spending patterns on cable TV and cell phone plans. If we assume a household could cut \$100 each month on cable subscriptions and another \$100 on cell phones, and stuff that \$200 per month under the mattress for thirty years, they would be sleeping on \$72,000 at the end of a couple decades. If we took that \$200 and invested it at a reasonable 8 percent annual return, as historically provided by a passive index fund investment, it would grow to \$298,071.89! This is remarkable considering data from the 2014 US Census reveals that average net worth for an American household at traditional retirement age (sixty-five to sixty-nine years old) is only \$194,226. If you subtract home equity, the average net worth for those in their mid- to late-sixties is only \$43,921.